

# Panda HSK — User Guide

Welcome! **Panda HSK** helps you learn Chinese vocabulary for the **HSK 1-5** exams. Your study buddy is **Bao**, a panda who reacts as you learn — and who *grows up* as you master more words. This guide walks you through everything the app can do.

## Getting started

Open the app in any modern browser (Chrome, Safari, Edge, Firefox) on a phone, tablet, or computer. Nothing to install. Your progress saves automatically on your device.

At the **top**: Bao's seal logo and app name, your 🐼 **day streak**, and your **profile chip** (tap it to switch or create profiles). Below that is the **level menu**. At the **bottom** are four sections: **Study**, **Quiz**, **Browse**, and **Progress**.

## Choosing your course

At the top of Study, Quiz, and Browse there's a **Course** selector. Tap it to switch which vocabulary you're learning:

- **HSK 1-5** — the 3600-word official list, grouped by level (HSK 1, 2, 3, 4, 5).
- **Class lessons** — your course vocabulary, grouped by lesson (8.10, 8.17, ...), many with example sentences.

Each course keeps its **own memory progress**, so your HSK words and lesson words are tracked separately — but Bao grows from everything you learn across both. More courses can be added to the app later.

## Choosing your group (level or lesson)

The **level menu** appears on Study, Quiz, and Browse. Instead of a long row of buttons, it's now a single compact selector with a "**Choose Level**" label, the current group (for example **HSK 5 · 1600 words**), and a green ▼ button on the right that makes it clear you can tap to change it. Tap it to open the menu and pick a group; tap anywhere outside (or press **Esc**) to close it.

For the HSK course the groups are **HSK 1 / 2 / 3 / 4 / 5 / All**; for Class lessons they're each **lesson number** plus **All**. The app remembers your choice per course. (When new levels are added later, they appear here automatically.)

## Meaning languages — English, Thai, Japanese

On the **Study** screen there's a **Meanings** row with three buttons: **English**, ไทย, 日本語. Tap to turn each language on or off. Whatever you pick shows on the back of flashcards **and** in Browse. Turn off the languages you already know to test yourself, or turn on two at once to compare.

Thai and Japanese meanings are helpful AI-generated study drafts. They're reliable for everyday vocabulary; a native speaker may refine a few. **Note:** Thai and Japanese for **HSK 4 and HSK 5** are still being prepared. For levels that don't have them yet, the ไทย and 日本語 buttons are **hidden** in the Meanings row, so those cards simply show **English** until the drafts are added.

## 1. Study mode (flashcards)

This is where you learn at your own pace.

- **Tap the card** (or **Flip card**) to turn it over and see the pinyin, part of speech, and meaning(s).
- **Swipe left** for the next card, **swipe right** to go back. On a computer you can **drag** with the mouse, use the ◀▶ **buttons**, or the **arrow keys**. Tap or press **Space** to flip.
- 汉字 / 拼音 / **Meaning first** — choose which side shows first.
- 🗣 **speaker** sits at the **center-bottom of both the front and back** of every card, so you can hear a word before or after flipping. Tapping it just plays the sound — it no longer flips the card.
- ★ (**star**) on a card flags it for extra review (find these later under Browse → ★ Review, or quiz them).

### Rating a word (how memory tracking works)

After you flip a card, four buttons appear:

| Button | Use it when...     | Effect               |
|--------|--------------------|----------------------|
| Again  | You didn't know it | Comes back very soon |

|      |               |                       |
|------|---------------|-----------------------|
| Hard | You struggled | Comes back soon       |
| Good | You knew it   | Comes back later      |
| Easy | Too simple    | Comes back much later |

Your honest rating sets when the word returns. Each word carries a status that grows with you:

New → Learning → Familiar → Mastered

- 🔍 **Study due** loads only the words that are ready for review right now.
- 🔀 **Shuffle** mixes the deck; ↺ **Restart** goes back to the beginning.

The deck now shuffles automatically each time you start (or switch group/course), so you no longer always begin at the same first word. Use ↺ **Restart** any time for a fresh shuffle.

## 2. Quiz mode

Tap **Quiz**, then set up your test:

- Type** — **Meaning** (汉字 → meaning), **Hanzi** (meaning → 汉字), **Listening** (hear it → pick the 汉字), or **Mixed** (a bit of each).
- Pool** — **This level**, **Due for review** (words ready to revisit), or **Marked hard** (your ★ words).
- Length** — 10, 20, or 30 questions.

Tap **Start quiz**. Pick the answer; Bao stamps 很好! for correct ones. Your quiz answers also update each word's memory status, so quizzing *is* studying. At the end you'll see your score, the XP you earned, and any new best. **Study missed** turns the words you got wrong into a quick review deck.

## 3. Browse mode

Tap **Browse** to see the whole list.

- Search** by hanzi, pinyin (with or without tone marks), English, Thai, or Japanese.
- Filter** by status: **All**, **New**, **Learning**, **Familiar**, **Mastered**, or ★ **Review**.
- Each row shows its HSK level and current memory status. Tap 🎧 to listen.

## 4. Progress (your dashboard)

Tap **Progress** to meet your panda and see how you're doing:

- Bao's stage** — your panda evolves as you master words: **Panda Cub → Bamboo Scout → Clever Panda → Scholar Panda → Master Panda → Sage Panda**. The bar shows progress to the next stage.
- Stats** — total XP, day streak, words mastered, and quiz accuracy.
- Memory map** — how many of the current course's words are New / Learning / Familiar / Mastered.
- Mastery by level** — your mastered count for HSK 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5.
- XP — last 7 days** — a little bar chart of your recent effort.
- Recent activity** — your latest study, quiz, and mastery moments.

### Earning XP

You earn XP for rating cards, answering quiz questions, and a bonus each time you **master** a word. Studying on a new day keeps your **streak** alive.

## Profiles, back up & sync

Tap your **profile chip** (top-right):

- Switch or create profiles** — each keeps its own XP, streak, and memory progress. Great for sharing a device or keeping separate goals. Pick a name and a panda buddy emoji.
- Back up & sync** — there's no server, so your progress lives on this device. To move it, copy your **backup code** and paste it into the app on another device under **Restore from a code**. Keep the code somewhere stable, like a note or email to yourself.

## Tips for steady progress

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- A few minutes daily beats long, rare sessions — your streak and the 🕒 **Study due** pool are built for this.
- Rate honestly. "Good/Easy" too often means words won't come back when you actually need them.
- Use **Listening** quizzes to train your ear once the characters feel familiar.
- Star tricky words (★) and clear them with a **Marked hard** quiz.

Happy studying — Bao is rooting for you! 🌱